MineConnect | Final Work Placement Report

IT Business Analysis (BAGC) • Cambrian College

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Placement: MineConnect • Business Analysis Co-op Student • September 8–October 23, 2026

Professional portfolio: [INSERT YOUR PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO LINK HERE]

Executive Summary

This report documents a seven-week business analysis work placement at MineConnect, an Ontario mining supply and services association. The placement combined early-stage exploration of the Yapla membership and payment platform, review of membership and directory requirements, initial planning research for a province-wide Mining Supply and Services (MSS) industry study, and practical communications and administrative support. Activities also included newsletter and event postings, member-visit online-form work, an initial banner concept, team coordination, and progress reporting. The main contribution was to turn observations and source documents into usable findings, questions, and planning materials. The evidence does not establish that the CRM migration or provincewide study was completed during the placement.

1. Introduction and Organizational Context

MineConnect supports Ontario's mining supply and services ecosystem through membership, industry visibility, events, and related initiatives. During the placement, the organization was preparing to move membership-related work from Microsoft Dynamics 365 to Yapla. The transition required more than software familiarization: member categories, renewal rules, billing, historical records, directory functionality, and operational ownership needed clarification. At the same time, MineConnect continued regular newsletters, events and office operations.

My placement objectives were to apply business analysis techniques in a professional environment, understand organizational needs, produce useful documentation, support research and operations, and develop professional communication and self-directed learning skills.

2. Scope of Responsibilities

- Support exploration and implementation planning for Yapla and the membership transition.
- Review membership questionnaire content and document business rules, gaps and follow-up questions.
- Research approaches for a province-wide MSS industry study, including an initial RFP outline.
- Support newsletters, event postings, website content and office coordination.
- Assist with online member-visit questionnaires and an initial promotional banner concept.

3. Methods, Tools and Application of Business Analysis

3.1 System exploration and self-directed training

I inspected Yapla's Members, Membership Types, Payments, Website and Events areas and used matching Yapla Academy learning materials. This discovery approach helped distinguish visible configuration from missing information and produced an early findings report. A missing visible import control was treated as a question to confirm with support, rather than proof that importing was impossible.

3.2 Requirements analysis and documentation

I reviewed a member and membership discovery questionnaire and extracted rules about categories, eligibility, fixed-date renewals, subsidiary relationships, prorating and supplier-directory functionality. I documented open questions rather than inventing requirements, applying elicitation, gap analysis and stakeholder communication practices from the IT Business Analysis program.

3.3 Research and communications tools

For the MSS study, I reviewed earlier sector studies and Statistics Canada sampling concepts and drafted an approach to selecting research consultants. Microsoft 365 and PDF documents supported communication and reporting; Canva supported a draft partner-banner design. The member-visit questionnaire work involved a Forms build sheet and a Google Form, with attention to question structure and response handling.

4. Development Process and Milestones

Initial phase: onboarding and discovery

At the beginning of the placement, I explored Yapla modules, identified configuration and migration questions, reviewed training resources, and prepared a Day 1 Yapla findings report. The report covered member records, membership types, payment settings, website structure and event setup. An early weekly report also recorded the membership questionnaire review, a meeting about Yapla events, and a draft banner for a September ministerial visit.

Development phase: requirements, research and operational support

I reviewed MineConnect's members questionnaire, summarized membership and directory requirements, and drafted follow-up questions for decisions requiring supervisor or vendor input. I also researched prior MSS economic studies and survey methodology, proposing a sampling framework and draft RFP evaluation criteria. Across the placement, I supported newsletters, event uploads and updates, website-related tasks, meetings and other office activities.

Concluding phase: forms, documentation and continuing support

I worked with short and long member-visit questionnaire materials, created or used a build sheet specifying question types and branching, and reported creating a Google Form. The available record does not confirm whether both versions were fully deployed or transferred into Microsoft Forms. My final report and presentation consolidate the placement evidence and outstanding recommendations for handover.

5. Key Deliverables and Evidence

Yapla Platform Assessment and Findings Report

Summary of five modules, observed settings and six questions for the supervisor.

Members discovery review

Extracted membership structure, data-migration issues and directory capability questions.

Weekly progress report

Documented Yapla training, questionnaire review, events discussion and initial banner work.

MSS study planning notes

Initial research, stratified sampling considerations, draft RFP outline and proposed consultant evaluation weights.

Member-visit form work

Short/long questionnaire build guidance and Google Form implementation reported by the student.

Communications and operations

Newsletter/news and event posting, website-related support, meetings and general office duties.

6. Findings, Analysis and Recommendations

6.1 Membership configuration and migration

The early Yapla review found no configured membership types or visible member list in the areas examined. The discovery questionnaire supplied business rules for Corporate, Associate, Individual and Corporate subsidiary membership, including a fixed November 1–October 31 membership year and prorating considerations. Existing data exports were possible from the CRM and accounting software, while exporting company profiles from the website required webmaster confirmation. Recommended next steps: confirm

sourcedata ownership, define field mapping and test a controlled migration with vendor guidance.

6.2 Payments and directory requirements

The early review identified a payment fee configuration choice that warranted supervisor confirmation; the precise rate and treatment of larger transactions should be revalidated against current Yapla terms before implementation. Directory requirements included differentiated Corporate and Associate visibility, synonyms for mining equipment and services, filters, and potential multilingual search. Recommended next steps: agree on business rules and validate them in realistic user scenarios before launch.

6.3 Industry study planning

The MSS study planning notes examined comparable Canadian studies and advocated a defensible sampling frame extending beyond current association members if provincewide representativeness is desired. Suggested stratification dimensions were company size, subsector, geography and membership status. A draft RFP outlined deliverables and proposed weighted criteria covering relevant experience, methodology, team, cost, schedule and references. These were initial proposals for review, not a completed commissioned study.

6.4 Member questionnaire and data handling

The member-visit forms required choices about required fields, branching, response ownership, and handling potentially sensitive answers. The Google Form created during the placement should be reviewed with the organization to confirm the preferred platform, ownership and access controls before operational use. Any public report or portfolio demonstration should omit identifiable member responses.

7. Challenges and Problem-Solving

Learning an unfamiliar platform

I used structured module exploration and Yapla Academy resources, then wrote down observations and questions.

Uncertain import capability

I avoided claiming a feature was unavailable merely because I could not locate it and flagged the question for vendor confirmation.

Complex membership and directory rules

I converted a long discovery questionnaire into a concise summary of requirements and unresolved decisions.

Balancing research and routine office support

I worked across system analysis, newsletters, event tasks and meetings while maintaining written updates.

8. Outcomes and Organizational Value

The placement generated actionable early-stage documentation for the Yapla transition, organized membership discovery findings, an initial research foundation for the MSS study, and support for day-to-day association communications. These contributions improved the visibility of decisions and follow-up questions. They should not be confused with completed production configuration, validated migration, or measured post-launch outcomes, none of which are established by the available evidence.

9. Learning Outcomes Alignment

VLO 1 – Requirements gathering

Reviewed questionnaires and platform screens to identify organizational needs.

VLO 2 – Analysis and gaps

Identified unresolved migration, eligibility, billing and search requirements.

VLO 3 – Requirements documentation

Prepared findings reports and a members discovery review.

VLO 4 – Process analysis

Considered onboarding, renewal, member-directory and form-response workflows.

VLO 5 – IT recommendations

Recommended capability checks, configuration decisions and migration validation.

VLO 6 – Client engagement

Communicated findings and questions through reports, meetings and office updates.

VLO 7 – Negotiation

Exposure was limited; no formal facilitated negotiation is evidenced.

VLO 8 – Test strategies

Exploratory checks and form logic considerations occurred; no formal test plan or executed UAT cycle is evidenced.

VLO 9 – Professional growth

Developed self-directed platform learning, documentation discipline and BA career direction.

CLO 1 – Placement preparation
Applied program preparation to the professional work placement.

CLO 2 – Professional behaviour
Participated in meetings, office tasks and supervisor communication.

CLO 3 – Applied BA competencies
Produced genuine requirements, research and documentation artifacts.

CLO 4 – Portfolio
Selected academic and permitted placement evidence for a professional portfolio; URL to be inserted.

10. Reflection and Professional Development
This placement strengthened my understanding that effective business analysis begins with clarifying organizational needs. Learning a new system was useful, but the larger challenge was understanding the decisions behind membership, payments, data migration and search. I learned to record observations carefully, ask precise questions, distinguish assumptions from verified facts, and communicate findings in a way that colleagues could act on. Research and communications tasks also improved my adaptability and awareness of how a business analyst contributes to everyday organizational work.

For future placements, I would seek early access to existing process documents and data samples, maintain a traceable requirements-and-decisions log, and plan a small formal validation checklist for configured features. I would also seek more opportunities to observe facilitated stakeholder decisions and formal testing.

11. Conclusion
My MineConnect placement connected classroom business analysis techniques to a live organizational transition and ongoing association operations. The most important outputs were structured findings, research notes, questionnaires and communications support. The experience increased my confidence in documenting complex business needs and collaborating in a professional setting. Remaining implementation questions should be resolved by MineConnect and its system partners as the Yapla rollout progresses.

12. Professional Portfolio
[INSERT YOUR PROFESSIONAL PORTFOLIO LINK HERE]

During the recorded presentation, open the portfolio in a browser and discuss one relevant project from semesters one or two and one MineConnect artifact only if the organization permits disclosure.

Appendix A — Source Documents Reviewed

- Cambrian College — Placement Final Presentation and Report Guidelines.
- Yapla CRM Platform Exploration and Findings Reports.
- MineConnect Membership Requirements and Discovery Review.
- MineConnect Members and Memberships Questionnaire.
- MineConnect Placement Progress Reports.
- Mining Supply and Services Industry Study — Research and Planning Documentation.
- Member Visit Questionnaire — Digital Forms Development Documentation.
- Yapla Platform Research, Training and System Analysis Materials.
- MineConnect Event Promotion and Digital Design Materials.
- Newsletter Preparation, Event Publishing, Website Content and Administrative Support Records.

Appendix B — AI Assistance Disclosure and Prompt Record

Throughout my seven-week placement at MineConnect, I carried out my assigned responsibilities, including system exploration, membership requirements review, industry research, digital form preparation, newsletter and event support, and documentation. I used AI tools selectively as supplementary resources to clarify concepts, review information, improve professional wording, and organize observations gathered through my work.

The research, system observations, workplace activities, and professional judgments presented in this report reflect my placement experience. AI assistance supported the communication and presentation of selected materials, as well as preparation of the final report and presentation. The following examples are drawn from the available conversation records.

AI tool / URL	Exact prompt	Purpose and application
Claude https://claude.ai	"Report"	Assisted with structuring my Yapla observations into a professional summary.
Claude https://claude.ai	"not yet here is the file which igo through already i want you to give me important outcomes"	Provided supplementary feedback on a membership questionnaire I had reviewed, helping refine the presentation of findings and clarification questions.
Claude https://claude.ai	"For the draft SS"	Clarified how questionnaire documents could be converted SS; I reviewed the requirements and worked on the form in the relevant platform.
ChatGPT https://chatgpt.com	"will you please convert this ppt into more profesional and mature ppt"	Assisted with presentation wording, formatting and visual organization using my placement documentation.
ChatGPT https://chatgpt.com	"Okay now go for it"	Assisted with organizing and drafting the final presentation and report from the information and supporting documents I supplied.

Independent contribution. My principal work involved hands-on system exploration, reviewing organizational documents, identifying requirements and open questions, researching industry information, supporting digital communications, and participating in office activities. AI was a supplementary resource and did not replace my workplace participation or responsibility for reviewing the final materials.